THREE POINTS LONDON

BRAND SYSTEM

threepointslondon.com — independent coverage of Arsenal, Chelsea and Tottenham for a global audience.

BRAND COLOUR — FROM THE MARK

Slate Navy
#1D2B45
Utility bar, footer, data panels

Indigo
#2B4BC4
Links, active nav, section rules

Ember Red
#CE3426
CTAs, live, exclusives, breaking

NEUTRALS

Page	Surface	Ink	Muted	Hairline
#FFFFFF	#F6F7F9	#111317	#5C6370	#E3E5EA

COMPONENTS

Contact ▾ | Read the piece | EXCLUSIVE | All Arsenal →

TYPE SCALE

DISPLAY — ARCHIVO 800 / 52 / -0.03em

Arsenal's title defence

HEADLINE — ARCHIVO 700 / 22

Alonso's build-up has changed three times

LONG-FORM BODY — NEWSREADER 400 / 19 / 1.7

Eleven games into the title defence, the underlying numbers point to one structural problem the results have been hiding.

EYEBROW / UI — ARCHIVO 800 / 11 / 0.12em · 11px FLOOR

TRANSFERS · EXCLUSIVE

CLUB WAYFINDING — OFF-CREST BY DESIGN

Arsenal	Chelsea	Tottenham
#E8192C	#1C6BB0	#24376B
crest red not used	crest blue not used	crest navy not used

Not one value on this sheet is a club's published colour. The three markers sit near enough to read as the right club and far enough to be ours — do not "correct" them to crest values during the build. They appear only as **3–4px rules, dots and bars**: never fills, never behind text, never on a button.

AD INVENTORY — RESERVED HEIGHTS

970×250	728×90	300×250	300×600
Below hero	In-feed	Rail	Sticky

In-content slots are responsive: 300×250, 336×280 and 320×100 from one tag, container reserving the tallest.

INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE — READER-LED

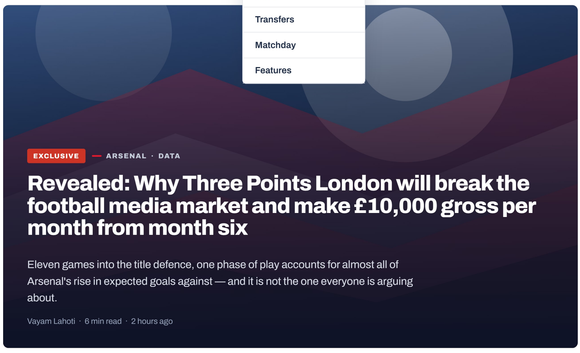
Clubs first. Trust pages in the footer.

About	Arsenal	Chelsea	Tottenham	Community	Contact ▾
Who We Are	News	News	News	Feed	Advertise / Guest Posting
The Team	Transfers	Transfers	Transfers	Hot topics	Write for us
Founder's Vision	Matchday	Matchday	Matchday	House rules	Feedback / Report an issue
Editorial standards	Features	Features	Features		

Four sub-sections per club. Twelve archives, every one with content on day one. Exclusives is a badge on the card and a filter on the club hub rather than a sixth archive, so original reporting appears wherever it belongs instead of in a shelf that fills once a week. Academy waits until the writing exists.

Data-led work lives in Features. There is no separate data archive to keep filled: a model, a chart or a season tracker publishes as a feature at /arsenal/features/ and carries a DATA tag. The numbers band on the homepage links straight into those pieces.

Desktop and mobile carry the same six tabs in the same order. One nav component, no divergence to maintain. About and Contact sit in the footer on every template.



EXCLUSIVE — ARSENAL · DATA

Revealed: Why Three Points London will break the football media market and make £10,000 gross per month from month six

Eleven games into the title defence, one phase of play accounts for almost all of Arsenal's rise in expected goals against — and it is not the one everyone is arguing about.

Vayam Lahoti · 8 min read · 2 hours ago

CHELSEA · TRANSFERS

The wage-structure question Chelsea must answer before January

Nathan Reeves · 4 hours ago

TOTTENHAM · FEATURES

De Zerbi's rebuild in five numbers: progression up, control down

Amelia Hart · 6 hours ago

AD — 970×250 BILLBOARD · BELOW THE LEAD STORY, HEIGHT RESERVED

THE THREE DESKS

ARSENAL

All Arsenal →

MATCHDAY

Player ratings: three standouts and one real worry at Villa Park

- Ranked: the eight Champions League opponents, easiest to hardest
- The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map
- Why the January window is already decided at the Emirates

CHELSEA

All Chelsea →

FEATURES

Alonso's build-up has changed three times in six weeks — here is the pattern

- Cobham's class of 2026: six names the first team is tracking
- What the registration rules actually permit in January
- Stamford Bridge redevelopment: where the plans stand

TOTTENHAM

All Tottenham →

EXCLUSIVES

Inside the recruitment meeting that reshaped the Spurs shortlist

- A trophy in February would change everything — and the draw says it is on
- The academy graduate quietly outplaying a £45m signing
- Transfers: the three positions Spurs will not leave until summer

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE FOOTBALL

Data-led features →

1.42
Arsenal xGA per game
Up from 0.91 at the same stage last season
The press is working. The rest-defence is not. →

68%
Chelsea build-up success
Third in the division under Alonso
Alonso's build-up has changed three times in six weeks →

+14
Spurs progressive passes
Per 90 since the De Zerbi switch
De Zerbi's rebuild in five numbers →

MOST READ

All three · Arsenal · Chelsea · Tottenham

1

CHELSEA · INTERVIEW

"We were told to stop playing out": a former Cobham coach on the academy's lost decade

Vayam Lahoti · 12 min read

2

ARSENAL · INVESTIGATION

The scouting network Arsenal quietly rebuilt in South America

Nathan Reeves · 9 min read

3

TOTTENHAM · REPORTING

Inside the recruitment meeting that reshaped the Spurs shortlist

Priya Shah · 10 min read

4

ALL THREE DESKS · INVESTIGATION

The agent who has brokered deals at all three London clubs — and what he says about January

Nathan Reeves · 14 min read

AD
300×600 HALF-PAGE
STICKY · SEQUENTIAL: 2–3 CREATIVES PER SCROLL · 30s VIEWABLE REFRESH

COMMUNITY

All rooms →

ARSENAL

312 online

REST-DEFENCE · HOT
Is the rest-defence actually a problem, or just variance?
214 · last reply 2m ago

TEAM NEWS
Saliba fit for Hull — does the back line change shape?
86 · last reply 18m ago

ACADEMY
Hale End: who earns real minutes before January?
51 · last reply 1h ago

MATCHDAY
Rate the Villa Park performance, honestly
33 · last reply 2h ago

Ar · Say something…

Open the Arsenal room →

CHELSEA

248 online

TRANSFERS · HOT
The wage structure: who is actually blocking January?
173 · last reply 5m ago

TACTICS
Alonso's third build-up pattern — better or worse?
92 · last reply 24m ago

ACADEMY
Cobham's class of 2026: which two make it?
44 · last reply 2h ago

MATCHDAY
Sunderland away: what does a good result look like?
28 · last reply 3h ago

Ch · Say something…

Open the Chelsea room →

TOTTENHAM

196 online

TRANSFERS · HOT
Three signings from a title race — which three?
198 · last reply 1m ago

TACTICS
De Zerbi's full-backs: brave, or reckless?
77 · last reply 31m ago

MATCHDAY
Carabao quarter-final: rotate, or go strong?
39 · last reply 1h ago

DATA
Progression is up. Is control actually down?
25 · last reply 4h ago

To · Say something…

Open the Tottenham room →

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300×600 HALF-PAGE
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AD
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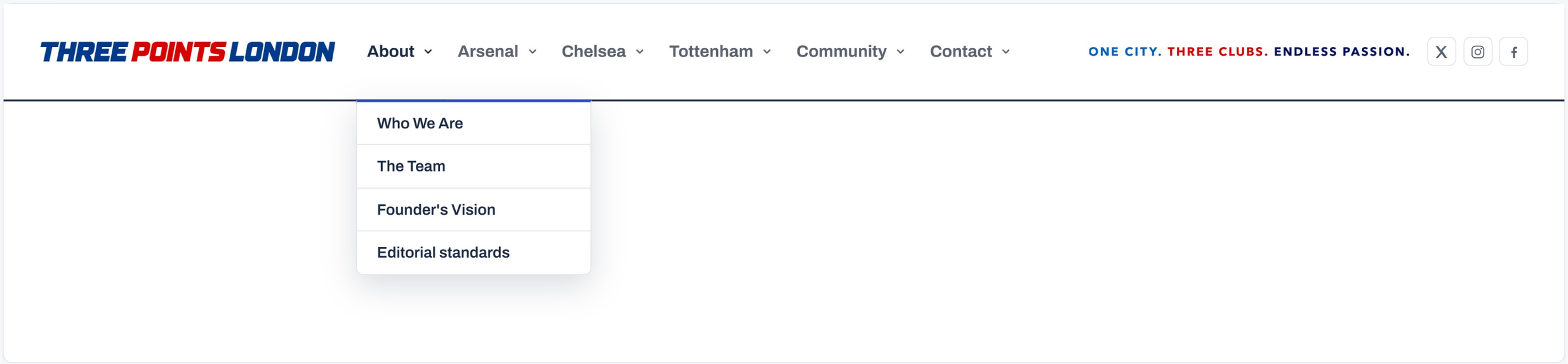
320×50 ON MOBILE · 30s VIEWABLE REFRESH

NAVIGATION STATES

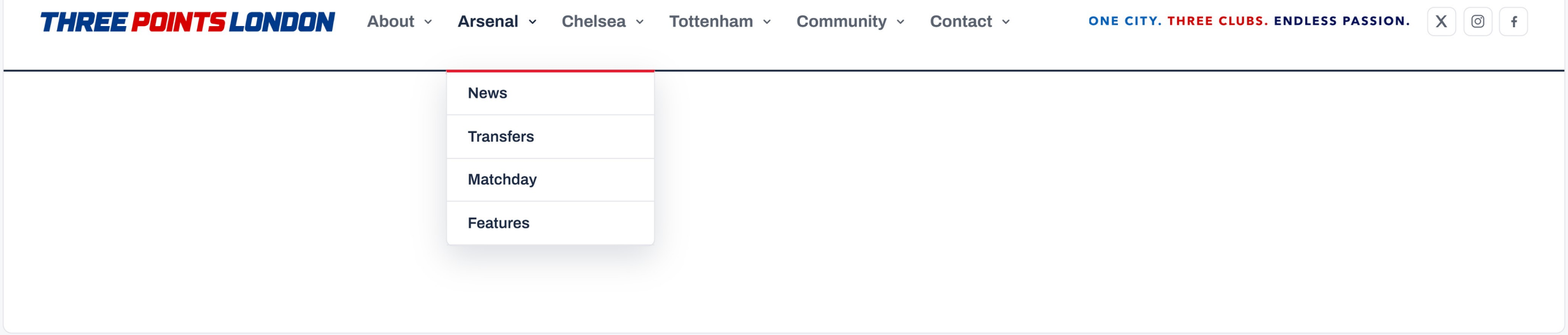
Six tabs, five drop-downs, one component

Every tab except Community opens a drop-down. The three club menus are identical in structure, so the developer builds one menu and passes it a club. Exclusives is a badge on the card and a filter on each club hub rather than a section of its own, which keeps the bar to six and stops original reporting being split off into an archive that fills more slowly than the rest.

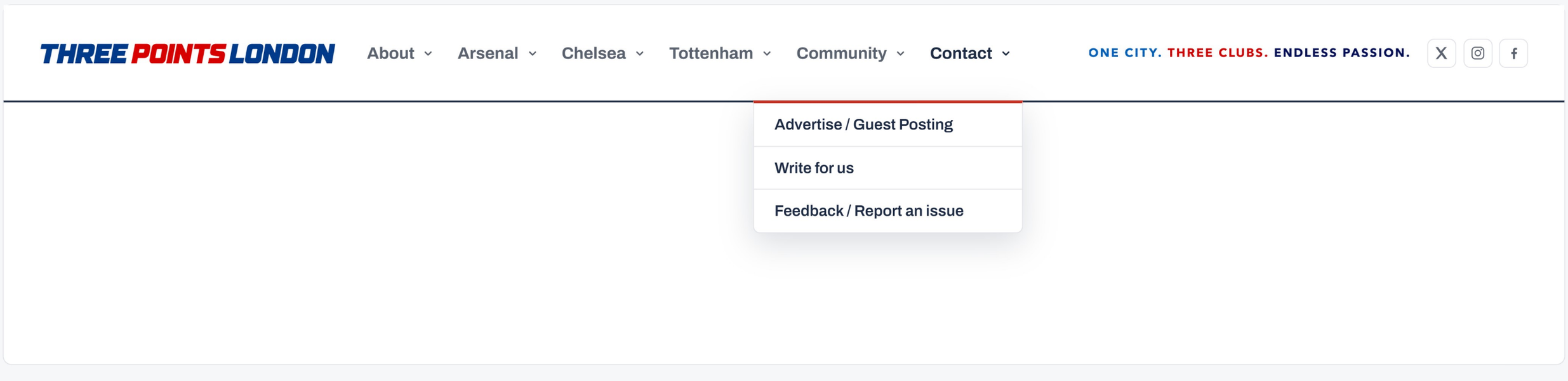
1 · About — the trust pages, one click from anywhere



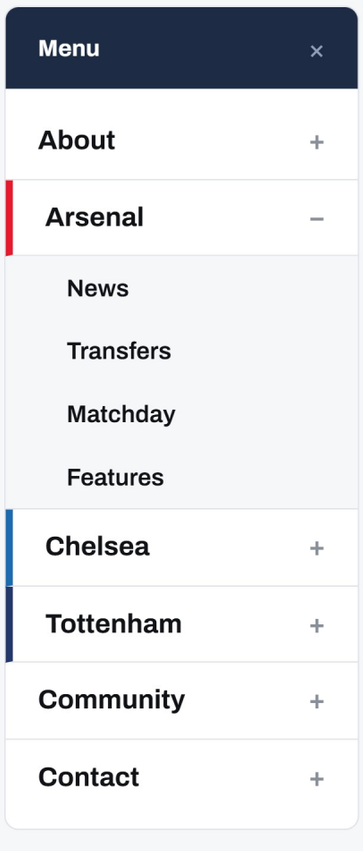
2 · Arsenal — four sub-sections, identical behind Chelsea and Tottenham



3 · Contact — three ways in, one tab



4 · Mobile drawer — the same IA, one tap deep



HOW THIS IS BUILT, AND WHY

One menu component, six instances. Arsenal, Chelsea and Tottenham pass the same four sub-sections and differ only by the colour of the top rule. About passes four pages, Community three, Contact three. Nothing here is a bespoke build.

Community filters by club, not by topic. The three rows are the same filter the feed already applies, surfaced one level up, so a reader arriving for one fanbase never lands in a mixed room by accident. /community/arsenal/ is a real URL, not a query string, so the club rooms are indexable in their own right.

Exclusives is a badge, not a section. Almost every exclusive is also a news, transfer or feature piece, so a section of its own would duplicate the others rather than divide them — the same article on two archives, splitting its internal links. It shows as the red chip on the card and as a filter on each club hub, which is where readers meet it anyway.

The header drop-down and the footer column are the same list, in the same order. Four sub-sections per club, twelve archives in all. A reader who learns one has learned the other.

The tagline sits in the header, not in the logo. Keeping *One city. Three clubs. Endless passion.* as a separate asset means it stays legible at header size and the wordmark stays clean on mobile, where the tagline is dropped entirely.

Transfers and Data remain hubs, not tabs. Both are reached from the club drop-downs, in-article links and the footer. Six tabs is what a reader scans in one pass.

The Arsenal Desk

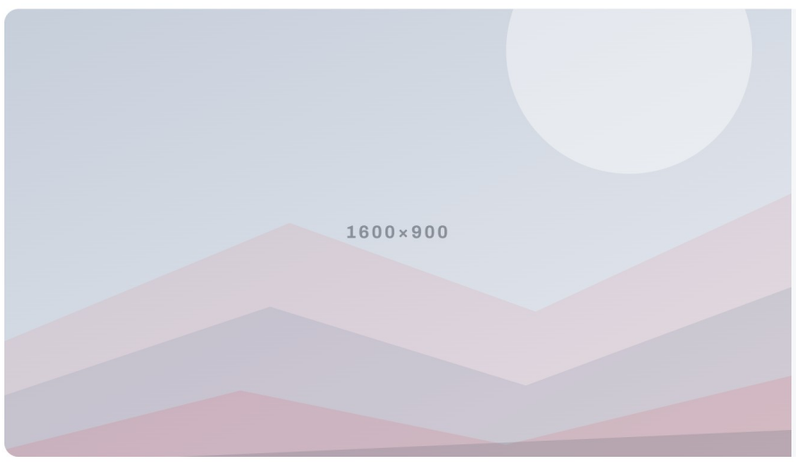
Your one-stop destination for all things Arsenal Football Club

POSITION 1st

POINTS 26

All · News · Transfers · Matchday · Features

EXCLUSIVES ONLY



EXCLUSIVE DATA

The press is working. The rest-defence is not.

One phase of play accounts for almost all of Arsenal's rise in expected goals against — and it is not the one everyone is arguing about.

Vayam Lahoti · 6 min read · 2 hours ago

MATCHDAY

Player ratings: three standouts and one real worry at Villa Park

Amelia Hart · 5h

TRANSFERS

Why January is already decided at the Emirates

Nathan Reeves · 7h

ACADEMY

The four Hale End teenagers who will train with the first team

Priya Shah · 9h

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MORE ARSENAL

FEATURES

The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map from the last six games

Two players used to share a channel. Now one covers it alone, and the data shows exactly where it breaks.

Vayam Lahoti · 8 min read · Yesterday

NEWS

Ranked: the eight Champions League opponents, easiest to hardest

The league phase draw is kinder than it looks on paper. We have modelled all eight.

Nathan Reeves · 5 min read · Yesterday

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EXCLUSIVE INVESTIGATION

The scouting network Arsenal quietly rebuilt in South America

Four appointments in eighteen months, none announced. We spoke to three of them.

Vayam Lahoti · 11 min read · 2 days ago

MATCHDAY

Villa Park tactical review: how the shape changed at half-time

A back three for thirty-five minutes, and a different game after it.

Amelia Hart · 7 min read · 2 days ago

Load more Arsenal

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EXCLUSIVE — ARSENAL · DATA ANALYSIS

The press is working. The rest-defence is not.

Eleven games into the title defence, one phase of play accounts for almost all of Arsenal's rise in expected goals against — and it is not the one everyone is arguing about.

VL · **Vayam Lahoti** · Founder & Editor
Published 6 October 2026, 09.15 BST · Updated 11:02 BST · 6 min read

Share · X · Save

Mikel Arteta watches from the technical area at Villa Park. IMAGO

Arsenal have conceded nine goals in eleven league games, a record that puts them second in the division for defensive solidity and has carried them to the top of the table. The problem is that the shots they are giving up do not look like the shots of a side top of the table.

Expected goals against has climbed from 0.91 per game at this stage last season to 1.42 this season — a fifty-six per cent increase — and almost all of that movement comes from one phase of play. Not set pieces, not the low block, but the moments immediately after Arsenal lose the ball high up the pitch.

AD — 728×90 IN-ARTICLE · UNIT 1 OF 3 · HEIGHT RESERVED

CHART

Expected goals against per game, first eleven matches

Premier League, 2022/23 to 2026/27. Lower is better.

Source: Opta via FBref, correct to 5 October 2026. Compiled by Three Points London.

Break the concessions down by phase and the picture sharpens. Arsenal are better than last season at defending the box, better from corners, and marginally better in open play against a settled opponent. Everything they have lost, they have lost in transition.

TABLE

Where the xGA has moved, by phase of play

PHASE OF PLAY	2025/26	2026/27	CHANGE
Counter-attack	0.21	0.68	+0.47
Open play, settled	0.44	0.41	−0.03
Set pieces	0.19	0.24	+0.05
High turnover against	0.07	0.09	+0.02
Total	**0.91**	**1.42**	**+0.51**

Phase definitions follow Opta's possession-chain model. Rounding means column totals differ by 0.01.

AD
336×280 IN-ARTICLE
UNIT 2 OF 3 · 320×480 ON MOBILE · LAZY-LOADED

Nearly half a goal per game, from one phase. Over a 38-game season that is roughly eighteen expected goals of additional exposure — historically, the difference between a title and a distant second.

> THE KEY POINT
>
> **The press has not stopped working. What has changed is who is left behind it when it fails.**

The full-backs are pushing five to seven metres higher than last season, and the single pivot now covers a channel two players used to share. On the whole it is a trade Arteta has made deliberately — Arsenal are creating more too. Whether it holds through a winter of midweek football is the question the next six weeks will answer.

AD
728×90 END OF ARTICLE
UNIT 3 OF 3 · HIGHEST-COMPLETION POSITION ON THE PAGE

VL · **Vayam Lahoti**
Founder and Editor of Three Points London. Journalism graduate of the University of Sheffield, previously editorial lead at a Premier League club brand with an audience of 2.5 million. Writes on tactics, recruitment and the numbers underneath both.
All pieces by Vayam · @vayamlahoti

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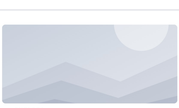
MORE ON THIS

Matched on subject, not on traffic

- DATA — Every Arsenal goal conceded this season, broken down by phase of play — 6 min read
- TACTICS — The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map from the last six games — 8 min read
- MATCHDAY — Villa Park tactical review: how the shape changed at half-time — 7 min read
- DATA — xGA across five seasons: where this Arsenal side actually sits — 5 min read
- FEATURES — Rest-defence is not a formation problem. It is a rehearsal problem. — 9 min read

READ NEXT

ARSENAL
The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map



CHELSEA
Chelsea have the same flaw — and nobody has punished it yet

TOTTENHAM
How De Zerbi's Spurs would attack this Arsenal side

IN THIS PIECE

- The nine goals are hiding something
- Five seasons of xGA, charted
- Phase by phase: where it moved
- What the next six weeks decide

NEXT UP — PREMIER LEAGUE

Arsenal v Hull City
Sat 7 Feb · 15.00 · Emirates

LAST TIME OUT — 2–0 Everton W

All Arsenal fixtures →

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AD
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SECOND UNIT IN THE STICKY RAIL

TRENDING — Last six hours, all three desks

1. Is the rest-defence a problem, or just variance?
2. The wage structure Chelsea must answer before January
3. Three signings from a title race — which three?
4. Hale End: who earns real minutes before January?

ARSENAL, AT A GLANCE

League position	1st
Goals conceded	9
xGA total	15.6
Clean sheets	5

HOW WE WORK

Every data piece names its source and its date. Where we are uncertain, we say so. Corrections are published, never quietly edited.

Our editorial standards →

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VL

AUTHOR

Vayam Lahoti

Founder & Editor · Arsenal, data and recruitment

Founder and Editor of Three Points London. Journalism graduate of the University of Sheffield (BA Journalism Studies, 2023), previously editorial lead at a Premier League club brand with an audience of 2.5 million. Writes on tactics, recruitment and the numbers underneath both. Former semi-professional footballer.

@vayamlahoti · LinkedIn · vayam@threepointslondon.com · Follow

ON THIS SITE

Pieces published	148
Exclusives	22
Writing since	2022
Main desk	Arsenal

EXCLUSIVE · ARSENAL · DATA

The press is working. The rest-defence is not.

One phase of play accounts for almost all of Arsenal's rise in expected goals against.

6 October 2026 · 6 min read

ARSENAL · FEATURES

The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map from the last six games

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5 October 2026 · 8 min read

ARSENAL · EXCLUSIVES

The scouting network Arsenal quietly rebuilt in South America

Four appointments in eighteen months, none announced. We spoke to three of them.

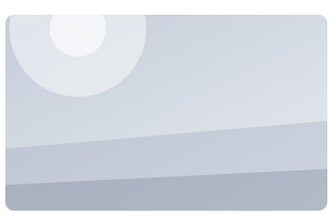
4 October 2026 · 11 min read

CHELSEA · INTERVIEW

"We were told to stop playing out": a former Cobham coach on the academy's lost decade

Twelve years at the club, four academy directors, and one instruction that changed everything.

2 October 2026 · 12 min read



TOTTENHAM · DATA

Every London signing of the summer, graded by the data

Thirty-one arrivals across three clubs, scored on minutes, output and fit.

30 September 2026 · 14 min read

1 · 2 · 3 · … · 15 · Next ›

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OTHER WRITERS

AH **Amelia Hart** — Arsenal correspondent

NR **Nathan Reeves** — Chelsea & transfers

PS **Priya Shah** — Tottenham & academies

Meet the full team →

FOLLOW VAYAM

Every piece, the moment it lands.

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THE COMMUNITY

Three clubs, one room

Argue about the football, share what you are reading elsewhere, and get answers from the people who write the site. Moderated, named, and open to all three fanbases.

- Arsenal
- Chelsea
- Tottenham

4,318 · POSTS TODAY 87 · ACTIVE NOW 212

Start a discussion

All · Arsenal · Chelsea · Tottenham · Transfers · Matchday · Off-topic

Hot · New · Top

VL · Share a link, or start a topic… · Link · Image · Poll · Post

14 new posts — tap to load

DK danny_k · ARSENAL · TOP CONTRIBUTOR · 4 hours ago · Matchday

Are we actually watching a rest-defence problem, or just variance? Eleven games is not a season

Read the xGA piece this morning and I buy most of it, but 0.47 of the jump comes from counters and we have played three of the four quickest sides in the league already. Genuine question for the people who track this properly — at what point does the sample stop being noise?

#xGA #arteta #tactics

248 · 31 · 64 comments · Share · Save · Report

VL Vayam Lahoti · EDITOR · 3 hours ago

Fair challenge, and I said as much in the piece. Phase-level xGA stabilises around fifteen to eighteen games, so we are not there. What makes me think it is signal rather than noise is that the full-back height has moved too, and that is a choice rather than a sample.

96 · 2 · Reply · Share

SM spursmatt · TOTTENHAM · 2 hours ago

Same thing happened to us under Ange and it took a full season for anyone to call it. The full-back height is the tell every time.

41 · Reply

VL · Add a comment… · Reply

Show all 64 comments →

RB rhys_bridge · CHELSEA · 6 hours ago · Transfers

Worth reading before anyone gets excited about January

SWISSRAMBLE.SUBSTACK.COM

Chelsea's amortisation cliff: what the 2026 accounts actually show

A breakdown of the squad cost ratio and why the January headroom is smaller than reported.

Not ours and not a TPL take — but it is the clearest thing I have read on the squad cost ratio, and it lines up with Nathan's piece last week.

#psr #january #offsite

176 · 9 · 38 comments · Share · Save

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AH Amelia Hart · WRITER · Yesterday · Matchday

Which London side finishes highest this season?

- Arsenal 54%
- Chelsea 31%
- Tottenham 15%

2,104 votes · closes Sunday

412 · 58 · 193 comments · Share

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HOUSE RULES

01 Argue with the point, never the person.

02 Credit and link anything that is not yours.

03 No tragedy chanting, no abuse, no leaks you cannot stand behind.

04 Rival fans are guests, not targets. All three badges live here.

Read the full rules →

HOT RIGHT NOW

1 **Rest-defence or variance?** 64 comments

2 **Who finishes highest?** 193 comments

3 **Cobham vs Hale End, settled** 88 comments

TOP CONTRIBUTORS

DK danny_k — 1,204 points this month

SM spursmatt — 988 points this month

RB rhys_bridge — 743 points this month

A NOTE ON MODERATION

Community posts are member-written and are not Three Points London editorial. They sit on **/community/** with **noindex** until a thread is worth indexing, and every outbound member link carries **rel="ugc nofollow"**.

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ABOUT · WHO WE ARE

One city. Three clubs. One newsroom that covers nothing else.

Three Points London is an independent publication covering Arsenal, Chelsea and Tottenham Hotspur. We are not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to any of them — and that independence is the point.

Who We Are · The Team · Founder's Vision

01

Who We Are

London has three of the most-followed football clubs in the world and, between them, several hundred million supporters who do not live anywhere near the city. Most of what is written for those supporters is written quickly, by people covering twenty clubs at once, and rewritten from somebody else's reporting.

We do the opposite. A small team, three clubs, fifteen pieces a day, and a standing rule that every piece must tell the reader something they could not have worked out from the scoreline. Some of that is original reporting. A lot of it is data, read properly and explained without jargon.

15
Pieces a day
Across all three desks, seven days a week

100%
Human-edited
Every piece carries a named byline and a named editor

0
Club affiliations
No access deals, no approval rights, no exceptions

HOW WE ARE FUNDED

Three Points London is funded by display advertising sold through a third-party network, and by clearly labelled commercial partnerships. Sponsored content is marked as sponsored, every time, at the top of the page. No advertiser sees a piece before publication, and no advertiser has ever been given approval over editorial. Where a piece mentions a betting operator, it is labelled, age-gated and carries responsible-gambling information.

Editorial standards → · Corrections policy → · Advertise with us →

02

The Team

Named writers, named beats, named credentials. Every byline links to a full profile and an archive.

VL — Vayam Lahoti
FOUNDER & EDITOR
Journalism graduate, University of Sheffield. Previously editorial lead at a Premier League club brand with 2.5 million followers. Covers tactics, recruitment and the numbers underneath both.

AH — Amelia Hart
ARSENAL CORRESPONDENT
Covers Arsenal home and away. Matchday reporting, player ratings and tactical reviews. Six years on the north London beat.

NR — Nathan Reeves
CHELSEA & TRANSFERS
Recruitment, contracts and the financial rules that shape both. Writes the transfer-window explainers that other outlets quote.

PS — Priya Shah
TOTTENHAM & ACADEMIES
Covers Spurs and the three London academies. Age-group football, pathways and the players about to arrive.

We commission freelance writers on all three desks
Paid per piece, named byline, your work edited rather than rewritten. Pitches welcome from anywhere in the world.

Pitch an idea

03

Founder's Vision

> "I spent five years writing about one club for an audience of two and a half million. The thing I kept running into was that the reader always wanted more than anyone had time to give them."
>
> VL — Vayam Lahoti, Founder

Three Points London exists because the gap between what football supporters are offered and what they actually want has never been wider. The volume is there. The depth is not. Aggregation has flooded the market, and the honest version of this business is that most sites covering these clubs would be indistinguishable if you removed their logos.

The plan is narrow on purpose. Three clubs, one city, six sections each. Every desk run by someone who covers that club and nothing else. Data treated as reporting rather than decoration. And nothing added to the site until the thing already there is good enough to keep people coming back.

WHERE THIS GOES

Year one	Launch all three desks at fifteen pieces a day. Establish the data desk as the thing people come for, and get named writers onto every byline.
Year two	A paid membership tier for the long-form and data work. Matchday live coverage. Video and audio built around the three derbies rather than a daily show nobody has time for.
Year three	A model that transfers. The six-section club template is deliberately generic — it works for any city with three clubs worth covering, and the next one is already obvious.

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UTILITY TEMPLATES

Static page, search results and 404

The three templates Snack's ad workflow expects alongside home, category, article and author. All three share the masthead, nav and footer components already defined, so your developer builds the chrome once.

page.php · static page template — used by Editorial Standards, Privacy, Terms, Advertise, Corrections

THREE POINTS LONDON

About ▾ Arsenal Chelsea Tottenham Community Contact ▾ Search

ON THIS PAGE

- What we publish
- Sourcing and attribution
- Use of AI tools
- Corrections
- Commercial content
- Complaints

Home › About › Editorial standards

Editorial standards

Last reviewed 1 October 2026 · Owner: Vayam Lahoti, Editor

Every piece on Three Points London carries a named byline and is read by a named editor before publication. Where a claim comes from somewhere else, we say where and we link to it. Where a claim is ours, we say how we know.

OUR USE OF AI — The clause readers and advertisers look for first

We use AI tools for research assistance, transcription, sub-editing and headline suggestions. We do not publish AI-generated articles. No piece reaches this site without a named human writer who has read every sentence and can answer for it.

WHAT WE DO USE IT FOR

- Transcribing interviews
- Searching documents and accounts
- Checking spelling, grammar and house style
- Suggesting headline options for a human to choose

WHAT WE NEVER USE IT FOR

- Writing or rewriting article copy
- Generating quotes, sources or detail
- Producing images presented as photography
- Publishing anything without human review

If that ever changes — if we publish anything with AI involvement beyond the list above — it will be labelled on the page, and this policy will be updated and dated before it happens, not after.

Corrections. If we get something wrong we correct it on the page, with a dated note explaining what changed. We do not quietly edit and we do not delete. To report an error, email corrections@threepointslondon.com.

AD 300×250

RELATED

- Who We Are
- The Team
- Corrections log
- Advertise with us

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search.php · search results

THREE POINTS LONDON Search

SEARCH

arsenal xga — Search

31 results for “arsenal xga”

All | Arsenal 24 | Data 18 | Newest

ARSENAL · DATA
The press is working. The rest-defence is not.
...expected goals against has climbed from 0.91 to 1.42 per game...

ARSENAL · FEATURES
The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map
...the channel two players used to share now shows up in the xGA split...

TOTTENHAM · DATA
Every London signing of the summer, graded by the data
...compared against Arsenal's equivalent cohort...

AD — 728×90 · BELOW RESULT 3

Search results carry **noindex, follow**. Never let them into the index — thin internal search pages are a classic scaled-content flag.

404.php · not found

THREE POINTS LONDON Search

404.

Offside. This page does not exist.

The link may be broken, or the page may have moved. Try the search below, or pick a desk and start again.

Search Three Points London — Go

Arsenal | Chelsea | Tottenham

LATEST INSTEAD

The press is working. The rest-defence is not.

Alonso's build-up has changed three times in six weeks

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Must return a real **HTTP 404** status, not a 200 with a "not found" message. Soft 404s waste crawl budget and show up in Search Console.

EXCLUSIVE — ARSENAL · DATA

The press is working. The rest-defence is not.

Vayam Lahoti · 6 min read · 2h ago

— CHELSEA · TRANSFERS

The wage-structure question Chelsea must answer before January

Nathan Reeves · 4h

— TOTTENHAM · FEATURES

De Zerbi's rebuild in five numbers

Amelia Hart · 6h

— ARSENAL · ACADEMY

The four Hale End teenagers who will train with the first team

Priya Shah · 9h

AD — 320×100 · UNIT 1 OF 2
FIRST AD, BELOW FOUR STORIES

THE THREE DESKS

— ARSENAL

MORE ARSENAL →

MATCHDAY

Arteta confirms Saliba fit to face Hull after the Villa Park knock

Amelia Hart · 4h

DATA

The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map

Vayam Lahoti · 8h

EXCLUSIVES

The scouting network Arsenal quietly rebuilt in South America

Nathan Reeves · Yesterday

TRANSFERS

Why the January window is already decided at the Emirates

Nathan Reeves · Yesterday

— CHELSEA

MORE CHELSEA →

TRANSFERS

Chelsea open talks over a January move for the Porto midfielder

Nathan Reeves · 2h

NEWS

Cobham graduate handed a first senior start at Sunderland

Priya Shah · 7h

FEATURES

“We were told to stop playing out”: a coach on the lost decade

Vayam Lahoti · Yesterday

NEWS

Stamford Bridge redevelopment: where the plans stand

Priya Shah · Yesterday

AD — 320×480 MID-SCROLL · UNIT 2 OF 2
Between CHELSEA and TOTTENHAM · 40% depth · lazy-loaded

— TOTTENHAM

MORE TOTTENHAM →

NEWS

Spurs confirm the Carabao Cup quarter-final date at the Lane

Priya Shah · 3h

TRANSFERS

De Zerbi: “We are three signings from a title race”

Nathan Reeves · 6h

EXCLUSIVES

Inside the recruitment meeting that reshaped the Spurs shortlist

Priya Shah · Yesterday

TRANSFERS

The three positions Spurs will not leave until summer

Amelia Hart · Yesterday

THE NUMBERS BEHIND THE FOOTBALL

1.42

Arsenal xGA per game

Up from 0.91 at the same stage last season

The press is working. The rest-defence is not. →

68

Chel

Third

Alons six w

MOST READ

All three · Arsenal · Chelsea · Tottenham

1 DATA
The rest-defence problem, in every number that matters

2 MATCHDAY
Player ratings: three standouts and one real worry at Villa Park

3 TRANSFERS
Why January is already decided at the Emirates

4 ACADEMY
The four Hale End teenagers who will train with the first team

Filtered to the desk a reader arrived through. Cold traffic sees all three.

COMMUNITY

All rooms →

— ARSENAL

● 312 online

REST-DEFENCE HOT

Is the rest-defence actually a problem, or just variance?

214 · last reply 2m ago

TEAM NEWS

Saliba fit for Hull — does the back line change shape?

86 · last reply 18m ago

ACADEMY

Hale End: who earns real minutes before January?

51 · last reply 1h ago

MATCHDAY

Rate the Villa Park performance, honestly

33 · last reply 2h ago

Ar · Say something…

Open the Arsenal room →

— CHE

TRANSFER

The wage blocking

173 ·

TACTICS

Alonso's or worse

92 ·

ACADEMY

Cobham' it?

44 ·

MATCHDAY

Sunderla result loo

28 ·

Ch · Sa

Open the C

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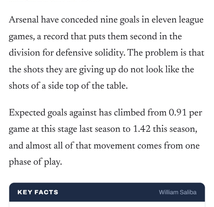
AD — 320×50 STICKY FLOOR · 30s REFRESH

EXCLUSIVE — ARSENAL · DATA ANALYSIS

The press is working. The rest-defence is not.

Eleven games into the title defence, one phase of play accounts for almost all of Arsenal's rise in expected goals against.

VL Vayam Lahoti · Editor
6 Oct 2026, 09:15 · Updated 11:02 · 6 min



Mikel Arteta at Villa Park. IMAGO

Arsenal have conceded nine goals in eleven league games, a record that puts them second in the division for defensive solidity. The problem is that the shots they are giving up do not look like the shots of a side top of the table.

Expected goals against has climbed from 0.91 per game at this stage last season to 1.42 this season, and almost all of that movement comes from one phase of play.

KEY FACTS	William Saliba
Position	Centre-back
Age	25
Nationality	France
Contract until	June 2030
Reported fee	£27m (2019)

AD — IN-CONTENT, RESPONSIVE · UNIT 1 OF 3
300×250 · 336×280 · 320×100
Never 728×90 — it does not fit this column

CHART

xGA per game, first eleven matches

Source: Opta via FBref, correct to 5 October 2026.

Break the concessions down by phase and the picture sharpens. Everything they have lost, they have lost in transition.

AD — 320×480 MID-SCROLL · UNIT 2 OF 3
Highest-CPM mobile display format
Lazy-loaded · 30s viewable refresh

THREE POINTS LONDON — THE VIEW

The press has not stopped working. What has changed is who is left behind it when it fails — and that is a choice Arteta has made, not an accident.

VL Vayam Lahoti, Editor

SOURCES

Match data from Opta via FBref. Contract detail from Transfermarkt, cross-checked against the club's 2025 accounts. Quotes taken from Arsenal's pre-match press conference, 5 October 2026, attended by this writer.

AD — 300×250 END OF ARTICLE · UNIT 3 OF 3
Highest-completion position
Above Read Next, not below it

MORE ON THIS

DATA
Every Arsenal goal conceded this season, broken down by phase of play
6 min read

TACTICS
The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map from the last six games
8 min read

MATCHDAY
Villa Park tactical review: how the shape changed at half-time
7 min read

DATA
xGA across five seasons: where this Arsenal side actually sits
5 min read

FEATURES
Rest-defence is not a formation problem. It is a rehearsal problem.
9 min read

NEXT UP — PREMIER LEAGUE

Arsenal v Hull City
Sat 7 Feb · 15:00 · Emirates

LAST TIME OUT — 2–0 Everton W

All Arsenal fixtures →

READ NEXT

ARSENAL
The single-pivot problem, explained with every touch map

CHELSEA
Chelsea have the same flaw — and nobody has punished it yet

TOTTENHAM
How De Zerbi's Spurs would attack this Arsenal side

DATA
Every London signing of the summer, graded by the data

TRANSFERS
The January window, club by club: who can actually spend

COMMUNITY
Members are arguing about this piece — 64 comments

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AD — 320×50 STICKY FLOOR · FIXED, OUT OF FLOW · 30s REFRESH

Search players, clubs, writers

- ABOUT +
- ARSENAL −
  - News
  - Transfers
  - Matchday
  - Features
- CHELSEA +
- TOTTENHAM +
- COMMUNITY 212 ACTIVE +
- CONTACT +

Independent coverage of Arsenal, Chelsea and Tottenham. Not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to any football club.

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AD STACK · FIVE OPTIONS, ALL TEMPLATES

THREE POINTS LONDON

What to run, where, and what each configuration costs you

Built from Snack's 2026 unit deck and their published size matrix. Each option is cumulative — every one contains the one above it. Pick a position on the ladder, not a pick-and-mix.

SNACK'S UNITS, SORTED BY WHAT THEY DO TO THE PAGE

SAFE — IN NORMAL LAYOUT FLOW

Standard Display Suite · Sidebar · In-Article MPU · Below-Video Leaderboard · Content Rec

STICKY — FIXED POSITION, OUT OF FLOW

Sticky Sidebar MPU · Sticky Sidebar Double MPU · Sticky Floor · Pre-Roll Video Player

HEAVY — WATCH INP AND LCP

Outstream Video · Programmatic Desktop Skin · Mid-Scroll Unit · In-Image Ad

INTERRUPTIVE — SEARCH AND DISCOVER RISK

Native Interstitial · Exit Ad · Ad-Wall · K-Words

SIZE MATRIX — AS SUPPLIED

Top billboard / leaderboard / MPU	728×90 · 970×90 · 970×250 320×100 · 320×50
In-content leaderboard / MPU	300×250 · 336×280 320×50 · 320×100 · 320×480
Sidebar MPU / double MPU	120×600 · 160×600 300×250 · 300×600
Video	640×480

Blue sizes are mobile. Every slot in the mock-ups is drawn at the largest size its family can serve, so reserved heights already accommodate the whole matrix.

THE FIVE OPTIONS

Cumulative — each adds to the one above

1 Baseline Display

Standard Display Suite only. Three slots a page, all in normal layout flow, nothing sticky and nothing that moves.

RPM: baseline · CWV: best · Discover: safe

HOMEPAGE	CATEGORY	ARTICLE	AUTHOR	STATIC & SEARCH	MOBILE
970×250 billboard 728×90 in-feed 300×250 rail	728×90 top 728×90 in-feed 300×250 rail	728×90 top 300×250 in-article 300×250 rail	728×90 top 300×250 rail	300×250 rail 404: none	320×100 top 300×250 in-content

Run this for the first two to four weeks. It gives you a clean Core Web Vitals baseline and Discover eligibility before anything heavier touches the page — so if something later breaks, you know exactly what did it.

2 Display + Sticky — RECOMMENDED AT LAUNCH — BUILT ON BOARDS 1 & 3

Adds Sticky Sidebar MPU, Sticky Sidebar Double MPU and Sticky Floor. Same number of ad calls, far more time in view — and viewable time is what CPM is priced on.

RPM: strong lift · CWV: low risk · Discover: safe

HOMEPAGE	CATEGORY	ARTICLE	AUTHOR	STATIC & SEARCH	MOBILE
970×250 billboard **1 × 336×280 in-feed** **300×600 sequential rail** **728×90 sticky floor** 4 slots — held down deliberately	728×90 in-feed **336×280 in-feed** **300×600 sequential rail** **sticky floor** 4 slots	728×90 in-article ×2 **336×280 mid-body** **double MPU sticky rail** **sticky floor** 6 slots	**300×600 sequential rail** **sticky floor** 2 slots — low traffic	300×250 rail **sticky floor** 404: none	Home: 320×100 + **320×480 mid-scroll** Article: 3-unit ladder incl. **320×480 mid-scroll** **320×50 sticky floor** **density 22% / 23% of 30% cap**

This is the standing configuration. The homepage runs lighter than the rest on purpose — it is a navigation surface, and every in-feed unit there taxes the click-through that produces the article pageviews where the revenue actually sits. Scroll depth is monetised through a sequential rail instead. Mobile is sized against the Better Ads 30% density ceiling rather than ported down from desktop: the homepage runs 22% and the article 23%, with the sticky floor excluded because it is fixed. Sticky units sit in `position: fixed`, outside layout flow, so they cost you nothing in CLS provided the floor never overlaps the last paragraph. Give `body` a bottom padding equal to the floor height.

3 Sticky + Video

Adds Outstream Video, Below-Video Leaderboard and the Pre-Roll Player. Video carries the highest CPMs in the whole stack by a wide margin.

RPM: highest per slot · CWV: INP risk · Discover: safe

HOMEPAGE	CATEGORY	ARTICLE	AUTHOR	STATIC & SEARCH	MOBILE
Option 2, plus **640×480 pre-roll player** below the desks block	Option 2, plus **outstream after result 4**	Option 2, plus **640×480 outstream** **728×90 below-video**	Option 2 unchanged	Option 2 unchanged no video on trust pages	Option 2, plus **outstream mid-article**

Add from month three, once matchday spikes are worth monetising. The player must lazy-load on intersection and sit well below the LCP element, with its 640×480 box reserved in CSS. A video player that initialises on page load is the single fastest way to fail the INP budget.

4 High Impact — sold, not always-on

Adds Programmatic Desktop Skin, Native Interstitial, Mid-Scroll, In-Image and Content Rec. Run these as named takeovers on derby weeks and deadline day.

RPM: spikes · CWV: mixed · Discover: conditional

HOMEPAGE	CATEGORY	ARTICLE	AUTHOR	STATIC & SEARCH	MOBILE
Option 3, plus **desktop skin** max 1140px content width	Option 3, plus **desktop skin** **content rec below feed**	Option 3, plus **in-image on lead** **content rec after body**	Option 3, plus **content rec**	Option 2 only never skin a trust page	Option 3, plus **320×480 mid-scroll** **interstitial: see below**

The skin is the safe one here — it is a CSS background behind a narrowed content column, so it costs nothing in performance and reads as premium. **The Native Interstitial is not.** Google's intrusive-interstitial guidance applies to mobile pages arriving from search, and an interstitial on a Discover landing is the one unit that can cost you the traffic you are monetising. If you run it, run it on desktop only, or on the second page view onward — never on entry.

5 Maximum Fill — NOT ADVISED

Everything remaining: Exit Ad, Ad-Wall and K-Words on top of Option 4. Listed for completeness so the decision is explicit rather than accidental.

RPM: highest on paper · CWV: poor · Discover: at risk

Ad-Wall

Gates the article behind an ad interaction. This is the textbook definition of an intrusive interstitial and it removes the page from Discover. It also breaks the "freely accessible" assumption behind your `isAccessibleForFree` schema.

Exit Ad

Fires on exit intent. Low direct SEO risk, high annoyance cost, and it lands on the reader at the exact moment you want them clicking a second article instead.

K-Words

Injects paid links into your body copy. On a site selling £500 betting placements, auto-inserted commercial links inside editorial is the fastest route to a link-spam problem you did not choose.

THE LADDER TO CLIMB

Weeks 1–4	Option 2 from day one. Revised — Option 1's three slots a page would need roughly three times the traffic for the same revenue. Measure CrUX in week 1 and pull a unit if LCP or INP moves.
Month 2	Turn on 30s viewable refresh on the sticky floor and sticky rail. Typically 25–40% on display revenue with no new slots. Ask Snack to configure it — it is not on by default.
Month 3+	Layer Option 3 outstream video, article template first, category second. Highest-CPM inventory you can run without producing video.
Big days	Option 4 skins sold as sponsorships. Interstitial desktop-only, if at all.
Never	Option 5. The Discover traffic is worth more than the incremental fill.

WHAT EXCLUSIVITY NOW MEANS FOR YOUR OWN REVENUE

Snack having exclusivity settles the slot question — every display position on these templates is theirs to fill. It also creates one you have not yet answered.

Your **£500 betting guest placements are sponsored editorial, not display inventory.** They are articles, not banners, so on a plain reading they sit outside an exclusivity clause written over ad units. But if that clause is drafted over "advertising revenue" or "commercial content" rather than over display slots, those placements are captured — and at your £5,000 a month target they are a large enough share that losing them changes the whole model.

Get a written carve-out before signing: sponsored articles, advertorial and direct brand partnerships sold by you, excluded from exclusivity, with Snack taking nothing on them. One clause. Ask for it now, while they want you on the platform.

BUILD SPEC · FOR THE DEVELOPER

Template inventory, performance budget, Open Graph and schema

THREE POINTS LONDON

Everything Snack's hosting lead asked for, in the form a WordPress developer can quote and build against. Acceptance criteria are at the bottom — nothing is signed off until they pass.

01 · TEMPLATE INVENTORY

TEMPLATE	WORDPRESS FILE	MOCK-UP	AD SLOTS	SCHEMA TYPE
Homepage	`front-page.php`	Done	970×250, 728×90, 300×250	WebSite + Organization
Category page	`category.php`	Done — "Club hub"	728×90 in-feed, 300×600	CollectionPage + Breadcrumb
Article page	`single.php`	Done	728×90 in-article, 300×600 sticky	NewsArticle + Breadcrumb
Author page	`author.php`	Done	300×600 sticky	ProfilePage + Person
Static page	`page.php`	Done	300×250 only	WebPage (+ AboutPage, ContactPage)
Search results	`search.php`	Done	728×90 below result 3	None — `noindex, follow`
404	`404.php`	Done	None	None — must return HTTP 404
Archive (date/tag)	`archive.php`	Reuses category.php	As category	CollectionPage

Mobile is a responsive state of each template, not a separate build. Header, nav, footer, card and ad-slot components are shared partials — built once, used by all eight.

02 · PERFORMANCE BUDGET

Measured on article page, mobile, PageSpeed Insights

LCP
< 2.0s
Good is 2.5s. Build to 2.0 so ads have headroom.

INP
< 150ms
Good is 200ms. Header bidding is the usual culprit.

CLS
< 0.05
Good is 0.1. This is the one ads break. Non-negotiable.

TTFB
< 400ms
Hosting-side. Full-page cache plus CDN required.

HOW THE BUILD HITS IT

Reserve every ad slot. Each container gets an explicit `min-height` matching its largest configured creative, set in CSS before any ad script runs. No collapsing containers, no auto-height.

No ad above the LCP element. On the article page the LCP element is the lead image. The 728×90 sits below the first text block, not above the headline.

Lazy-load ads below the fold via IntersectionObserver with a 200px root margin — fill rate holds, main thread stays free.

Self-host the two fonts as WOFF2 with `font-display: swap` and a preload on the display weight. No render-blocking Google Fonts request.

Images: AVIF with WebP fallback, explicit `width/height` on every tag, `fetchpriority="high"` on the lead, lazy on everything else. Source assets at 1600×900 minimum.

No jQuery, no page builder, no bundled slider. Vanilla JS under 40KB compressed, critical CSS inlined, the rest deferred.

Full-page cache plus object cache at the host, with the ad calls firing client-side so cached HTML stays valid.

Mobile header is 56px and sticky, and it is the only fixed chrome. Nav scrolls away with the page. Ask the designer for the supplied logo re-exported as a tightly-cropped asset at the sizes the header actually uses — the artwork is unchanged, but a padded square trimmed in CSS downloads pixels the reader never sees and softens on a 3× screen.

In-content slots are responsive, not fixed. A 728×90 cannot fit a phone column. Agree a responsive in-content placement with Snack that serves 300×250, 336×280 and 320×100 by viewport from one tag, with the container reserving the tallest of the set.

Type floor is 11px and every tap target is at least 44×44. Eyebrows and bylines below that fail both legibility and WCAG 2.2 target size.

News ticker is CSS-only. A `transform: translateX` keyframe on a fixed-height bar — no JavaScript, no reflow, no CLS. It pauses on hover and respects `prefers-reduced-motion`, which is a WCAG 2.2 requirement for anything that moves for more than five seconds.

03 · OPEN GRAPH & HEAD TAGS

Required on every template, populated per post

ARTICLE TEMPLATE — <head>

```
<title>The press is working. The rest-defence is not. | Three Points London</title>
<meta name="description" content="Eleven games in, one phase of play...">
<link rel="canonical" href="https://threepointslondon.com/arsenal/features/xga-rest-defence/">
<meta name="robots" content="max-image-preview:large, max-snippet:-1">

<meta property="og:type" content="article">
<meta property="og:site_name" content="Three Points London">
<meta property="og:title" content="The press is working. The rest-defence is not.">
<meta property="og:description" content="Eleven games in, one phase of play...">
<meta property="og:url" content="https://threepointslondon.com/arsenal/...">
<meta property="og:image" content=".../xga-1200x630.jpg">
<meta property="og:image:width" content="1200">
<meta property="og:image:height" content="630">
<meta property="og:locale" content="en_GB">
<meta property="article:published_time" content="2026-10-06T09:15:00+01:00">
<meta property="article:modified_time" content="2026-10-06T11:02:00+01:00">
<meta property="article:author" content="https://threepointslondon.com/author/vayam-lahoti/">
<meta property="article:section" content="Arsenal">

<meta name="twitter:card" content="summary_large_image">
<meta name="twitter:site" content="@3pointslondon">
<meta name="twitter:creator" content="@vayamlahoti">
```

SHARE PREVIEW — WHAT THE TAGS PRODUCE

threepointslondon.com
The press is working. The rest-defence is not.
Eleven games in, one phase of play accounts for almost all of Arsenal's rise in xGA.

PER-TEMPLATE OG TYPE

Homepage → `og:type=website`
Category → `og:type=website`, club hero as og:image
Article → `og:type=article` + article:* tags
Author → `og:type=profile` + profile:username
Static → `og:type=website`
Search / 404 → site-default OG, `noindex`

Every post needs a dedicated 1200×630 social image. Falling back to the lead image crops badly on X and in Discover.

04 · SCHEMA MARKUP

JSON-LD only, in <head>, validated against the Rich Results Test

ARTICLE — NewsArticle

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "NewsArticle",
  "headline": "The press is working. The rest-defence is not.",
  "description": "Eleven games in, one phase of play...",
  "image": [".../xga-1600x900.jpg", ".../xga-1200x1200.jpg"],
  "datePublished": "2026-10-06T09:15:00+01:00",
  "dateModified": "2026-10-06T11:02:00+01:00",
  "author": {
    "@type": "Person",
    "name": "Vayam Lahoti",
    "jobTitle": "Founder & Editor",
    "url": ".../author/vayam-lahoti/",
    "sameAs": ["https://x.com/vayamlahoti"]
  },
  "publisher": {
    "@type": "Organization",
    "name": "Three Points London",
    "logo": { "@type": "ImageObject", "url": ".../logo.png" }
  },
  "articleSection": "Arsenal",
  "isAccessibleForFree": true,
  "mainEntityOfPage": ".../arsenal/features/xga-rest-defence/"
}
```

SITE-WIDE — EVERY TEMPLATE

`Organization` with logo, founding date, contact point and `sameAs` social profiles — and `WebSite` with `SearchAction` so Google can show a sitelinks search box.

BREADCRUMBS — ARTICLE, CATEGORY, STATIC

`BreadcrumbList` matching the visible trail: Home › Arsenal › Features › headline. This is what replaces the raw URL in the search result.

AUTHOR PAGE — ProfilePage + Person

Name, job title, `alumniOf`, `knowsAbout`, `sameAs`. Author entities are how Google connects a byline across sites — the single cheapest E-E-A-T win available to a new publisher.

WORTH ADDING LATER

`SportsEvent` on fixture pages and `FAQPage` on explainers. Both earn rich results. Neither is launch-blocking.

05 · ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Final payment is released on all eight passing

PageSpeed mobile ≥ 90
On the article template, with the ad tags live — not on a clean page.

CLS ≤ 0.05 with ads
Measured three times on a cold load at 4G throttling.

Rich Results Test clean
Zero errors on article, category and author. Warnings documented.

OG debugger clean
Correct card on X, Facebook, WhatsApp and LinkedIn.

All eight templates built
Including 404 returning a real HTTP 404 and search set to noindex.

Ad slots reserved in CSS
Verified with ad scripts blocked — layout must not move when they load.

WCAG 2.2 AA
Contrast, focus states, keyboard nav through the mega-menu.

Child theme, documented
No core edits. Handover doc naming every file and hook.

WHERE SNACK NOW STANDS

Third-party theme: permitted. Display slots: Snack exclusive. Both settled, and the five stack configurations built on their unit deck sit on the Ad Stack board. Two things still need answering in writing. First, whether their tags can be deferred and lazy-loaded as specified above — the CLS and INP budgets depend on it, and no acceptance criterion here is meetable if they cannot. Second, an explicit carve-out for sponsored editorial you sell yourself, so the £500 guest placements are not swept up by an exclusivity clause written over "advertising revenue" rather than over display units.